

CLASS WILL
START AT
5:00 PM

Class 10th | English



First Flight

Chapter Name:

A LETTER TO GOD

A LETTER TO GOD

BEFORE YOU READ

They say faith can move mountains. But what should we put our faith in? This is the question this story delicately poses. Lencho is a farmer who writes a letter to God when his crops are ruined, asking for a hundred pesos. Does Lencho's letter reach God? Does God send him the money? Think what your answers to these questions would be, and guess how the story continues, before you begin to read it.

Blind Faith

Protagonist (main character OR HERO)

G.L. FUENTES



A LETTER TO GOD



Lencho

THE house — the only one in the entire valley — sat on the ^{top} crest of a low hill. From this height one could see the river and the field of ripe corn dotted with the flowers that always promised a good harvest. The only thing the earth needed was a downpour or at least a shower. Throughout the morning Lencho — who knew his fields intimately — had done nothing else but see the sky towards the north-east.

"Now we're really going to get some water, woman." —> IMP — Extract Q.

Lencho's wife

meal & dinner.

"The woman who was preparing supper, replied, "Yes, God willing". The older boys were working in the field, while the smaller ones were playing near the house until the woman called to them all, "Come for dinner". It was during the meal that, just as Lencho had predicted, big drops of rain began to fall.



A LETTER TO GOD

In the north-east huge mountains of clouds could be seen approaching. The air was fresh and sweet. The man went out for no other reason than to have the pleasure of feeling the rain on his body, and when he returned he exclaimed, "These aren't raindrops falling from the sky, they are new coins. The big drops are ten cent pieces and the little ones are fives."

Compare

Raindrops

IMF

With a satisfied expression he regarded the field of ripe corn with its flowers, draped in a curtain of rain. But suddenly a strong wind began to blow and along with the rain very large hailstones^{oole} began to fall. These truly did resemble new silver coins. The boys, exposing themselves to the rain, ran out to collect the frozen pearls.



A LETTER TO GOD



"It's really getting bad now," exclaimed the man. "I hope it passes quickly." It did not pass quickly. For an hour the hail rained on the house, the garden, the hillside, the cornfield, on the whole valley. The field was white, as if covered with salt. Imp

Not a leaf remained on the trees. The corn was totally destroyed. The flowers were gone from the plants. Lencho's soul was filled with sadness. When the storm had passed, he stood in the middle of the field and said to his sons, "A plague of locusts would have left more than this." My The hail has left nothing. This year we will have no corn." That night was a sorrowful one. "All our work, for nothing." "There's no one who can help us." "We'll all go hungry this year."

insect



A LETTER TO GOD

Oral Comprehension Check

1. What did Lencho hope for? *Rain*
2. Why did Lencho say the raindrops were like 'new coins'? *good harvest → profit*
3. How did the rain *hailstorm* change? What happened to Lencho's fields? *destroyed / 1 hour hailstorm*
4. What were Lencho's feelings when the hail stopped?
[Statement]

A LETTER TO GOD

the family members only/single

But in the hearts of all who lived in that solitary house in the middle of the valley, there was a single hope: help from God.

what was Lencho's only hope?

"Don't be so upset, even though this seems like a total loss. Remember, no one dies of hunger."

innocent

Blind Faith in God

Naive

Educated

Hardworking

"That's what they say: no one dies of hunger." All through the night, Lencho thought only of his one hope: the help of God, whose eyes, as he had been instructed, see everything, even what is deep in one's conscience. Lencho was an ox of a man, working like an animal in the fields, but still he knew how to write. The following Sunday, at daybreak, he began to write a letter which he himself would carry to town and place in the mail. It was nothing less than a letter to God.



A LETTER TO GOD



"God," he wrote, "if you don't help me, my family and I will go hungry this year. I need a hundred pesos in order to sow my field again and to live until the crop comes, because the hailstorm...."

He wrote 'To God' on the envelope, put the letter inside and, still troubled, went to town. At the post office, he placed a stamp on the letter and dropped it into the mailbox.

One of the employees, who was a postman and also helped at the post office, went to his boss laughing heartily and showed him the letter to God. Never in his career as a postman had he known that address. The postmaster — a fat, amiable fellow — also broke out laughing, but almost immediately he turned serious and, tapping the letter on his desk, commented, "What faith! I wish I had the faith of the man who wrote this letter." Starting up a correspondence with God!"

IMP

A LETTER TO GOD

So, in order not to shake the writer's faith in God, the postmaster came up with an idea: answer the letter. But when he opened it, it was evident that to answer it he needed something more than goodwill, ink and paper. But he stuck to his resolution: he asked for money from his employees, he himself gave part of his salary, and several friends of his were obliged to give something 'for an act of charity'.

It was impossible for him to gather together the hundred pesos, so he was able to send the farmer only a little more than half. He put the money in an envelope addressed to Lencho and with it a letter containing only a single word as a signature: God.



A LETTER TO GOD

Oral Comprehension Check

1. Who or what did Lencho have ^{his only} faith in? What did he do? Letter to God.
2. Who read the letter? Postmaster.
3. What did the postmaster do then? Collected some pesos → self, apne employees,
P.M - friends.
↓
act of charity.

A LETTER TO GOD

The following Sunday Lencho came a bit earlier than usual to ask if there was a letter for him. It was the postman himself who handed the letter to him while the postmaster, experiencing the contentment of a man who has performed a good deed, looked on from his office.

Lencho showed not the slightest surprise on seeing the money; such was his confidence — but he became angry when he counted the money. God could not have made a mistake, nor could he have denied Lencho what he had requested.

A LETTER TO GOD

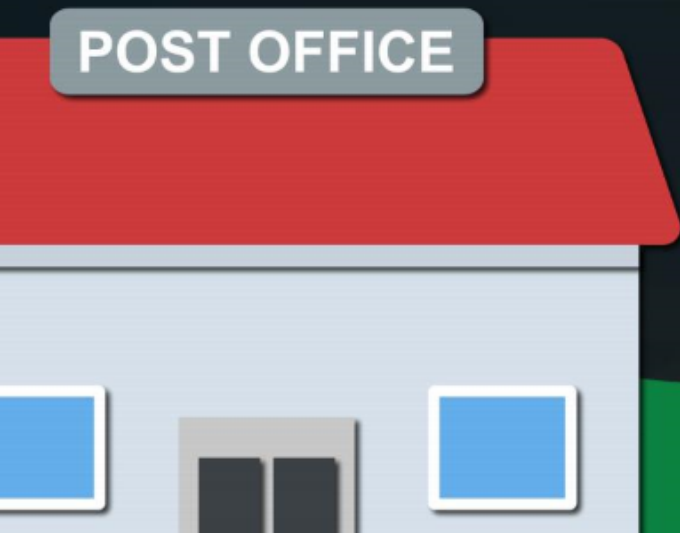
Immediately, Lencho went up to the window to ask for paper and ink. On the public writing-table, he started to write, with much wrinkling of his brow, caused by the effort he had to make to express his ideas. When he finished, he went to the window to buy a stamp which he licked and then affixed to the envelope with a blow of his fist. The moment the letter fell into the mailbox the postmaster went to open it. It said: "God: Of the money that I asked for, only seventy pesos reached me. Send me the rest, since I need it very much. But don't send it to me through the mail because the post office employees are a bunch of crooks. Lencho."

A LETTER TO GOD

Oral Comprehension Check

1. Was Lencho surprised to find a letter for him with money in it?
2. What made him angry?

POST OFFICE



Themes

Undying faith in God

Power of belief

Potential for kindness and compassion, even in the face of adversity

Setting

Set in a small, unnamed Latin American village where Lencho, a farmer, lives with his family and depends on his crops for survival. Their house was on the crest of a low hill.



Character Analysis

Postmaster

- Dutiful - The postmaster takes his job seriously and is dedicated towards his duty.
 - Empathetic - Despite being initially surprised by Lencho's letter to God, the postmaster shows kindness towards Lencho's situation and tries to help him.
 - Pragmatic - The postmaster understands the limitations of the system and makes a sensible decision to collect money from his mates to help Lencho.
 - Helpful - The postmaster goes out of his way to collect money from his mates to help Lencho, even though he is not required to do so.
- God Fearing- He does not want Lencho to lose his Faith in God.

Character Analysis

Character Sketch of Lencho

- Devout - Lencho is deeply religious and has a strong faith in God, which is evident in his letter to God for help in the story.
- Honest - Lencho is an honest man who never cheats or lies, as evidenced by his trust in the postman to deliver his letter to God.
- ^{Naive} Simple - Lencho is a simple man who leads a simple life and has simple aspirations, which is shown in his letter to God asking for just enough money to survive.
- Determined - Lencho is a determined man who does not give up easily, as seen in his unwavering belief in God's ability to provide him with the help he needs.

STAY CONNECTED

KEEP LEARNING

Thank You



Join our telegram channel
@ABHAY_BATC H2024BOARDS

